Burmese-directed order. The Burmese troops were able to drive the Yunnanese forces from Kengtung back to the banks of the Mekong River, killing the Chinese commander in the process. After the Green Standard troops in Yunnan failed to capture Kengtung, the Qianlong emperor (r. ca. 1735–1795) sent his elite Manchu troops in an effort to reassert control. Despite the overwhelming military superiority the Qing dynasty was unable to defeat the Burmese. In fact, Chinese troops suffered a series of crushing defeats to the Burmese despite Chinese claims of victory.

Following a four-year campaign, a truce was reached by field commanders of the opposing sides at the end of 1769, with the invading Qing unable to conquer the Burma. In order to maintain the status quo the Qing dynasty maintained a substantial military presence in the Yunnan border area in an attempt to wage another war. Burma and China would not establish further diplomatic contact until 1788, when they exchanged diplomatic missions. The Sino-Burmese conflict had several important consequences for Burma. First, the Burmese controlled the equilibrium of the Burma-China relationship. Second, the Burmese maintained control of the border areas, while the Shan saw-bwas adjudicated local matters. Third, it illustrated the strength of the administrative and military reforms implemented by Alaùngpayà.